

Design System v1

Provisional. This is the visual grammar, not the finished book. Real Part I text throughout, so what you are judging is how the book reads, not how a specimen reads.

Every component below is set so it survives grayscale. Nothing in this system means anything by colour alone: each callout is separated by rule weight, rule style, indentation, and the small sans-serif label. A reader photocopying a page loses nothing.

ORDINARY NARRATIVE

I was not about to persuade him, and he was not about to persuade me.

If he came back with three more verses, I would go looking for four. The exchange had a shape, and the shape was that whoever runs out of ammunition first concedes, and whoever concedes is taken to have been wrong.

That is not an argument. It is an inventory contest.

The problem is not that the verses are fake. Every verse in both stacks is really there. The problem is that stacking them tells you nothing, because there is no step in the procedure

where evidence decides anything. There is only a step where somebody gets tired.

SCRIPTURE

Scripture sits inside the measure with a single heavy rule, at slightly smaller size and set ragged-right so it never reads as body text. No italic, because italic across four lines of Hebrew idiom is tiring.

Go into all the world and proclaim the good news to every creature (Mark 16:15)

Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? (1 Corinthians 12:29)

Body text resumes here so you can see the transition back.

JOHN THE BAPTIST

A first-century Jewish prophet who called Israel to repentance and prepared the way for Yeshua. He is not the same person as John the apostle, traditionally associated with the Gospel of John and with Revelation.

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Second Temple Judaism is the name for Jewish religious life between the rebuilding of the temple after the Babylonian exile and its destruction by Rome in the year 70. It is the world Yeshua and the apostles lived in, and it was not a single uniform movement.

WHERE STRUCTURE IS THE POINT

Most of this book is prose. But when the thing being described *is* a structure, the reader should see the structure rather than excavate it.

HOW CLAIMS ARE LABELED

- **EXPLICIT TEXT** — the passage says it
- **STRONG CUMULATIVE INFERENCE** — many independent lines converge
- **PROBABLE RECONSTRUCTION** — my best account of how the pieces fit
- **HISTORICAL OBSERVATION** — something about the world, checkable
- **HYPOTHESIS** — under test, not established
- **OPEN QUESTION** — deliberately not claimed

Those are six **kinds** of claim, not six rungs of one ladder. A historical observation is not weaker than a probable reconstruction; Jerusalem was destroyed in the year 70 is about as

firm as anything in this book. And an open question is a status, not a faint conclusion.

The genuine scale is separate, and it measures something else entirely: how hard a given piece of evidence bears on whatever claim is in front of it.

HOW STRONGLY EVIDENCE BEARS

**CONTRADICTS → PERMITS → SUPPORTS → RE-
QUIRES**

Most of what gets called proof lives at *permits*, which only means the claim can survive next to the evidence. Where something only permits, this book says so, including where I would rather it required.

Two tools, two questions. *What kind of claim is this?* and *how hard does this evidence press on it?* Collapsing them is the single easiest way to launder a guess into a finding, which is why they do not share a component.

ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

εὐαγγελίζω · *euangelizō* · to announce good news

Acts 8:4 uses it of the scattered believers, not of the apostles, who had stayed in Jerusalem (8:1). What the word establishes: proclamation is happening and these people are doing it. What it does not establish: what commission they understood themselves to be under.

שָׂרָף מְעוֹפֵף · *saraph me 'opheph* · Isaiah's flying fiery serpent, set here only to prove the Hebrew renders and sits on the line correctly.

TEXTUAL NOTE

RVR1960 reads **EL PACTO**, singular, at Romans 9:4, where several English editions read the plural. Behind it sits a known Greek variant. I do not resolve it here and do not need to. The Spanish edition carries this note; the English edition does not need one.

FINDINGS AND CHECKPOINTS

FINDING

The saints in Revelation are Yah's covenant-faithful people identified with Yeshua, characterized by keeping Yah's commandments, holding the testimony of Yeshua, and enduring opposition rather than surrendering their allegiance. Martyrdom is prominent among them but does not exhaust the category.

A finding carries the heaviest rule in the system, because it is the only component that asserts a result.

WHERE WE ARE. A relative pressed the outward-proclamation side with Mark 16, Matthew 28, James 4:17 and Acts 8:4. I answered that preaching was not my calling, and underneath that I was treating the Great Commission as already fulfilled in the first century. Neither of us could settle it, because proof-texting cannot adjudicate between two stacks of real verses.

WHAT IT EARNED. He asked me how I had reached my reading of prophecy and I could not answer in any short way. So the question became: what method would let this be settled by evidence rather than by whoever cites last?

Those two are deliberately a pair. The checkpoint closes with rules above and below; the question it earned continues from it, indented, so the eye reads them as one movement and not two boxes.

OPEN QUESTION

I have quoted “all nations” and “all the world” in this chapter without examining either. Whether those phrases meant to their first hearers what they mean to a modern reader is not settled until Chapter 23.

The open question is the only dashed component in the book. Dashed because it is not closed.

THE GROWING CHAIN

Yeshua's first-century prophetic horizon



apostolic mission and judgment expectation



Gentiles incorporated into Israel's covenant story



MILLENNIUM



YOU ARE HERE: ?

WHAT IS STILL OPEN IN THE DESIGN

Running heads are not set. Chapter openers do not yet drop or use a display size. Part title pages do not exist. Trim size is provisional at six by nine. Final pagination is meaningless until Parts II through IX are drafted, and the components those Parts will need have not all appeared yet.